

smartphone that I have used with the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chip, and the performance jump is substantial, to say the least.

While Qualcomm has still stuck to the 4nm process for this next-gen chip, the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 on the iQOO 12 offers quite a jump as compared to the 8 Gen 2. In synthetic benchmarks, the iQOO 12 put out some of the highest performance figures that we have come across so far. On AnTuTu, this is the first smartphone to cross the 2 million mark in terms of the score. When I ran the benchmark, the iQOO 12 put out a score of 2,119,219 points on AnTuTu. Now, AnTuTu isn't the best indicator of the smartphone's real world performance, but it tests the maximum performance of a smartphone. In other CPU benchmarks also, as expected, the iQOO 12 easily beats the other flagships that we have tested in the recent past. I also experienced none to minimal throttling while using the iQOO 12, which indicates that neither does the smartphone heat up too much and even if it does, the heating doesn't result to a drop in performance.

Further, in GPU benchmarks, the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 and 16GB of RAM allows the iQOO 12 to put out substantially higher scores than some other flagships. At times, the iQOO 12 even put out doubt the score as compared to some other flagships. Here, the smartphone's thermals also come into play. I experience minimal to no heating, even during long gaming sessions at the maximum possible graphics settings. So yes, the performance is good. So good that the jump in performance from the SD 8 Gen 2 may deserve another story in itself. Performance wise, there are no issues. In fact, the iQOO 12 is one of the most powerful smartphones that has come to our test lab so far.

CAMERA

While the performance is incredible, the iQOO 12 is also a beautiful camera device. This is the first time that iQOO has put a major focus on the camera, and the results are just brilliant! The smartphone comes with a 50-megapixel primary shooter, a 64-megapixel telephoto lens, and another

50-megapixel ultra-wide angle lens. The photos from the iQOO 12 are now at a proper flagship level. I tested the camera before the smartphone's launch during an exclusive session in Jaisalmer and was instantly impressed with the results. Photos from the primary shooter are full of detail, showcase spectacular dynamic range, and retain colours also quite well.

While the primary shooter with a 1/1.3-inch sensor is obviously great, what I loved the most is the periscope telephoto lens. The iQOO 12 this time has a 10X optical zoom, thanks to the periscope telephoto lens. Photos in 10X zoom are just superb. Another thing that pleasantly impressed me is the macro on the iQOO 12. The smartphone has a super macro feature that engages 3X and 6X optical zoom to give you a super detailed shot of a close-by subject. After the telephoto lens, I found myself playing around with this camera feature the most.

So overall, this is a massive improvement in the camera space for iQOO. In fact, I can safely say that the iQOO 12 is probably the best camera device from iQOO so far. Don't get me wrong, it's not the perfect camera device. There are misses like at times the smartphone smoothens the skins and texture on the subject and there are times the portrait mode messes up the edge detection. But all of that can be sidelined because the overall camera setup offers a major improvement, making the iQOO 12 a lucrative phone not only for the gamers and enthusiasts, but also for those looking for a flagship phone without spending more than Rs 55,000.

BATTERY

Coming to another very important factor that a lot of people make their buying decision on, battery. The battery on the iQOO 12 is also very good. We get a 5,000mAh unit which is good for a screen-on-time of 6 hours comfortably. If you are a casual user then you can easily squeeze out more than 6.5 hours or even 7 hours with this battery potentially.

The battery tests also show decent results. A 15 minute game of Call of Duty: Mobile only drained 4 percent of the battery, despite the game running on full

graphics and frame rate settings. Even watching a YouTube video on 2160p at a higher level brightness drained the battery by 4 percent only. Coming to charging, the iQOO 12 retains the 120W fast charging that we have seen on other iQOO smartphones as well. The iQOO 12 charged from 0 to 100 percent in just 31 minutes in our charging test, which is great. Again, the 120W fast charging isn't really good for your battery, but there are different schools of thought around this.

VERDICT

So overall, the iQOO 12 is a brilliant flagship from the Vivo sub-brand. For the first time ever, an iQOO flagship has felt like a proper flagship, going beyond just performance and focusing on things that users look for when making an over Rs 50,000 purchase. Now, while it does miss out on a lot of flagship features like wireless charging or an official IP rating. But what we do get, is probably the best camera setup that we have ever seen on any iQOO smartphone.

Furthermore, iQOO has gone with a new design, with the BMW M-Motorsport branding now being much more subtle and small. I like the new camera module design also. So overall, it is a very good upgrade over the previous iQOO flagship, the iQOO 11 – not just in terms of the performance (thanks to the Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 chip), but also in terms of the camera, which a lot of people in this segment look for.

–Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Android v14 | Thickness: 8.1mm | 203.7g | In Display Fingerprint Sensor | 6.78inch, LTPO AMOLED Screen | 1260x2800 pixels | 453 ppi | HDR10+, P3 Color Gamut, Curved Display, 3000nits Brightness, 2160Hz High frequency PWM dimming | 144 Hz Refresh Rate | Punch Hole Display | Main Camera: 8K @ 30 fps UHD Video Recording | 16 MP Front Camera | Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen3 Chipset | 3.3GHz, Octa Core Processor | 12GB RAM + 12GB Virtual RAM | 256GB Inbuilt Memory | Connectivity: 4G, 5G, VoLTE | Bluetooth v5.4, WiFi, NFC | USB-C v2.0 | IR Blaster | Battery: 5000mAh Battery | 120W Fast Charging | Wireless Charging

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